

Customer Journey = What the customer experiences

Service Design = How the organisation designs the entire service to create that experience

Customer Journey Mapping

What is a Customer Journey?

A **customer journey** is the series of steps a customer goes through when interacting with a company.

For example, when ordering food online:

Search for restaurant → View menu → Place order → Pay → Wait → Track delivery → Receive food → Give review

The customer does not experience only the final product. They experience **every interaction along the journey**.

What is Customer Journey Mapping?

A **Customer Journey Map** is a visual representation of the customer's experience.

It normally shows:

- Customer actions
- Customer needs
- Customer emotions
- Pain points
- Touchpoints
- Opportunities for improvement

Example: Online Food Delivery

Imagine a customer orders dinner through a food delivery application.

Journey Stage	Customer Action	Emotion	Pain Point
Search	Looks for restaurant	😊 Interested	Too many choices
Menu	Reviews menu	😊 Positive	Menu information unclear
Order	Places order	😄 Excited	Payment process complicated

Journey Stage	Customer Action	Emotion	Pain Point
Waiting	Waits for food	😐 Neutral	No delivery update
Delivery	Receives food	😊 Happy	Food arrives
Review	Rates restaurant	😊 Satisfied	Wants easy feedback

The company can then identify:

The biggest problem occurs during the waiting stage.

So it might introduce **real-time delivery tracking**.

2. Customer Pain Points

A **pain point** is something that frustrates, confuses, delays or inconveniences the customer.

Common examples

- Long waiting time
- Complicated registration
- Too many forms
- Slow website
- Difficult payment process
- Repeatedly providing the same information
- Poor customer support
- Lack of order updates
- Having to switch between different channels

Real-world example: E-commerce

Imagine a customer purchases a laptop.

The customer receives:

"Order confirmed."

But then receives no information for three days.

The customer asks:

"Where is my order?"

The company could improve this pain point with:

Order confirmed → Packed → Shipped → Out for delivery → Delivered

with notifications at each stage.

3. Moments of Truth

A **moment of truth** is an important interaction where the customer's perception of the company can significantly change.

For example, imagine checking into a hotel.

The customer may have already:

1. Seen the hotel advertisement.
2. Visited the website.
3. Made a booking.

But the **check-in experience** can strongly influence their overall impression.

Positive moment

Receptionist says:

"Welcome. We have your reservation ready. Your room is on the 12th floor."

Fast and smooth.

Negative moment

Customer arrives after a long flight and hears:

"We can't find your reservation. Please wait."

This creates frustration.

Digital example

For an online bank:

Customer submits loan application → waits several days → receives no update

The waiting period becomes an important moment of truth.

A better design could provide:

Application received ✓
Documents verified ✓
Under review 🔄
Decision expected tomorrow

4. Customer Emotions

Customer journey mapping also looks at **how the customer feels**.

For example:

Excited → Confused → Frustrated → Relieved → Happy

Understanding emotions helps companies identify where service improvements are needed.

Example: Airline booking

A passenger may experience:

Search flight

😊 Excited

↓

Compare prices

😬 Uncertain

↓

Payment fails

😡 Frustrated

↓

Payment succeeds

😌 Relieved

↓

Receives confirmation

😄 Happy

The payment failure is an obvious opportunity for service improvement.

5. Touchpoints

A **touchpoint** is any interaction between the customer and the organisation.

Touchpoints can be:

Digital

- Website
- Mobile app
- Email
- Social media
- Live chat
- Online payment

Physical

- Store
- Reception counter
- Product packaging
- Delivery
- Salesperson

Human

- Customer service agent
- Salesperson
- Technician
- Receptionist

Real-world example: Starbucks

A customer journey might include:

Instagram advertisement

↓

Mobile app

↓

Store locator

↓

Mobile ordering

↓

Payment

↓

Store pickup

↓

Product

↓

Customer feedback

Each is a **touchpoint**.

If the mobile app says:

"Order ready"

but the drink is not actually ready, the problem may not be the product itself—it is the **connection between digital and physical touchpoints**.

6. Omnichannel Touchpoints

This is an important concept in the slide.

What is Omnichannel?

Omnichannel means providing a consistent customer experience across multiple channels.

For example:

Website + Mobile App + Physical Store + Social Media + Customer Service

should work together.

Example: Retail

Imagine a customer searches for a pair of shoes online.

The website shows:

Size 42 available at Store A

The customer visits Store A.

The staff should be able to see the same inventory information.

The customer could also:

Buy online → Pick up in store.

This is an integrated experience.

7. Multichannel vs Omnichannel

Students often confuse these two.

Multichannel

The company has several channels:

Website

App

Store

Facebook

But they may operate separately.

Omnichannel

The channels are connected.

For example:

Customer adds product to cart on website

↓

Opens mobile app

↓

Same cart appears

↓

Chooses store pickup

↓

Store receives order

↓

Customer receives notification

The experience is connected.

Easy way to remember:

Multichannel = Many channels

Omnichannel = Many connected channels

8. Service Blueprinting

This is one of the most important concepts in LO3.

A **service blueprint** looks at both:

Frontstage

What the **customer can see**.

and

Backstage

What the **organisation does behind the scenes**.

Example: Food Delivery

Customer-facing process

Customer opens app

↓

Selects restaurant

↓

Places order

↓

Tracks driver

↓

Receives food

These are **frontstage activities**.

But behind the scenes:

Order enters restaurant system

↓

Restaurant receives order

↓

Kitchen prepares food

↓

Delivery platform assigns driver

↓

Driver collects food

↓

GPS tracks driver

↓

Customer receives notification

These are **backstage processes**.

9. Why Service Blueprinting Is Useful

Imagine customers complain:

"The app says my food is ready, but I still have to wait 20 minutes."

A customer journey map tells us:

Customer is frustrated at the waiting stage.

But the service blueprint helps identify **why**.

Maybe:

App says "Ready"

↓

But restaurant hasn't actually finished cooking.

The problem is therefore not just the customer interface.

It is a **backstage operational problem**.

10. Another Example: Hotel Check-In

Frontstage

Customer:

Arrives → Gives booking details → Receives room key → Enters room

Backstage

Hotel:

Reservation system → Guest verification → Room status check → Housekeeping confirmation → Key-card system

Suppose the customer arrives at 2 PM but the room isn't ready.

The customer experiences:

 "I have to wait."

The service blueprint might reveal:

Housekeeping information is not updated in real time.

Solution

Connect:

Housekeeping app → Hotel PMS → Reception

When housekeeping marks:

Room 1205 = Clean

the reception system immediately knows the room is ready.

11. Service Design

What is Service Design?

Service design means designing the entire service experience so that customer needs and organisational processes work together effectively.

It isn't simply:

"Make the website look nice."

It considers:

Customer + Employees + Processes + Technology + Systems + Physical Environment

Real-World Example: Online Banking

A bank wants to make account opening easier.

Old process

Customer:

1. Visits website
2. Downloads form
3. Prints form
4. Fills form
5. Scans form
6. Emails form
7. Waits
8. Receives phone call
9. Visits branch
10. Provides documents again

This is poor service design.

Redesigned service

Mobile app

↓

Digital identity verification

↓

Upload documents

↓

Automatic validation

↓

Application submitted

↓

Bank employee reviews exceptions

↓

Account activated

↓

Customer receives notification

The customer journey becomes shorter, while the bank's backstage processes become more efficient.

12. Frontstage vs Backstage

A useful classroom example is **McDonald's self-ordering kiosk**.

Frontstage

Customer:

Walks in → Uses kiosk → Selects food → Pays → Receives order

Backstage

System:

Order transmitted → Kitchen receives order → Food preparation → Order status updated → Staff prepares collection

The customer doesn't need to see the internal system.

But if the kitchen system doesn't receive the order correctly, the customer's experience suffers.

This demonstrates:

A good frontstage experience depends on good backstage operations.

13. Connecting Customer Journey Mapping and Service Blueprinting

These two concepts complement each other.

Customer Journey Map asks:

"What is the customer experiencing?"

Service Blueprint asks:

"What is happening inside the organisation to create that experience?"

For example:

Customer experience

"My food delivery is late."

Journey map

Identifies:

Pain point = Long waiting time

Service blueprint

Investigates:

Restaurant preparation delay?

Driver allocation delay?

Incorrect preparation-time estimate?

Poor communication between systems?

This allows the company to identify the underlying operational problem.

14. Complete Real-World Example: E-Commerce

Consider a customer buying a smartphone.

Stage 1 — Discovery

Customer sees advertisement.

Touchpoint: Instagram / Google

Customer thinks:

"This phone looks interesting."

Stage 2 — Consideration

Customer visits website.

Touchpoint: Website

Customer compares:

- price
- specifications
- reviews
- delivery options

Stage 3 — Purchase

Customer adds product to cart.

Touchpoint: Website

Problem:

Checkout requires too many fields.

Pain point: Complicated checkout.

Stage 4 — Payment

Customer pays.

Touchpoint: Payment gateway

Problem:

Payment fails but customer doesn't know why.

Pain point: Poor payment feedback.

Stage 5 — Fulfilment

Warehouse receives order.

Backstage:

Inventory system checks availability.

Warehouse picks and packs product.

Stage 6 — Delivery

Courier receives delivery information.

Touchpoint: Tracking system

Customer sees:

"Out for delivery."

Stage 7 — Post-Purchase

Customer receives phone.

Touchpoint: Email / App

Customer receives:

"How was your experience?"

Customer submits review.

15. Example Customer Journey Map

Stage	Customer Action	Touchpoint	Emotion	Pain Point	Improvement
Discover	Sees advertisement	Social media	😊	Too many similar products	Better targeting
Research	Compares products	Website	😬	Information difficult to compare	Comparison tool
Purchase	Checks out	Website	😬	Too many fields	Simplify checkout
Payment	Pays	Payment gateway	😬	Payment failure	Better error messages
Delivery	Tracks order	App	😬	Tracking updates delayed	Real-time tracking
Receive	Receives product	Courier	😄	—	—
Review	Gives feedback	App/email	😊	Review process long	One-click review

16. Key Concepts Students Should Remember

Customer Journey Mapping

Visualise the customer's experience from beginning to end.

Focus on:

Actions + Touchpoints + Emotions + Pain Points + Opportunities

Service Blueprinting

Connect the customer experience with the organisation's internal processes.

Focus on:

Frontstage + Backstage + Employees + Technology + Processes

Touchpoint Optimisation

Improve the interactions between customers and the organisation.

Example:

Slow checkout → Simplified checkout.

Omnichannel

Provide a consistent and connected experience across channels.

Example:

Website → App → Store → Customer Service

all share relevant customer/order information.

17. Easy Memory Formula

Students can remember LO3 using:

JOURNEY → BLUEPRINT → TOUCHPOINT → IMPROVE

1. JOURNEY

What does the customer do?

2. BLUEPRINT

What happens behind the scenes?

3. TOUCHPOINT

Where does the customer interact with us?

4. IMPROVE

How can we remove pain points and create a better experience?

Quick Classroom Question

Give students this scenario:

A student wants to enrol in a private education institution. The student discovers the school through social media, visits the website, sends an enquiry, receives a reply, submits an application, makes payment, receives an offer letter, attends orientation and begins classes.

Ask students to identify:

1. **At least 8 customer journey stages**
2. **The touchpoint at each stage**
3. **The customer's likely emotion**
4. **At least 3 pain points**
5. **Three opportunities for improvement**
6. **The backstage process supporting each customer interaction**
7. **Which processes could be digitised or automated**

This scenario is particularly useful because students can clearly see the relationship between **customer experience, service design, digital touchpoints and internal operations**.